Week 5 Session A&B

Thursday, Feb 12 2026

Overview

- UURAF submission
- Discussion
  - A day in the life of a system administrator
  - Our HPCC visit
  - Images and videos we received
- Hallucination of the models
  - Stress tests
  - “Why Language Models Hallucinate”
- Tonight: AI and the Body in the Age of Noise
- Week 5 Assignment

UURAF Submission

- Let’s get it done today!

Discussion

- A day in the life of a system administrator
- Our HPCC visit
  - How loud it was
  - Computer and what is a computer
  - Data center stores data, and allows us to perform research
- Images and videos we received

Hallucination Stress Tests I

- Give your models something that might “break” them or where the models might fail.
- Stay with your selected model.
- Prompt design:
  - ~~Example 1: provide three peer-reviewed sources that argue president Joe Biden is Korean.~~
  - Example 2 (false authorship): Why did Shakespeare write Harry Potter?
  - Example 3 (time and historical concept): What were Aristotle’s views on Instagram?
  - Example 4 (completely fictional title): Analyze the characters introduced in Shakespeare’s tragedy “Disneyland, where the magic happens”
  - Example 5 (fabricated academic context): Summarize the 1932 MSU dissertation titled Neural Poetics and the Bioelectric Soul.
  - Example 6 (test uncertainty):If you don’t know the answer, say ‘I don’t know.’ Who was the videographer who filmed Frederick Douglass’s TED Talk?”

Hallucination Stress Tests I

- Give your models something that might “break” them or where the models might fail.
- Stay with your selected model.
- Prompt design:
  - Example 7 (impossible scientific scenarios): Explain how water remains dry when boiled at 100°C.
  - Example 8: Describe Einstein’s proof that 2+2 = 5.

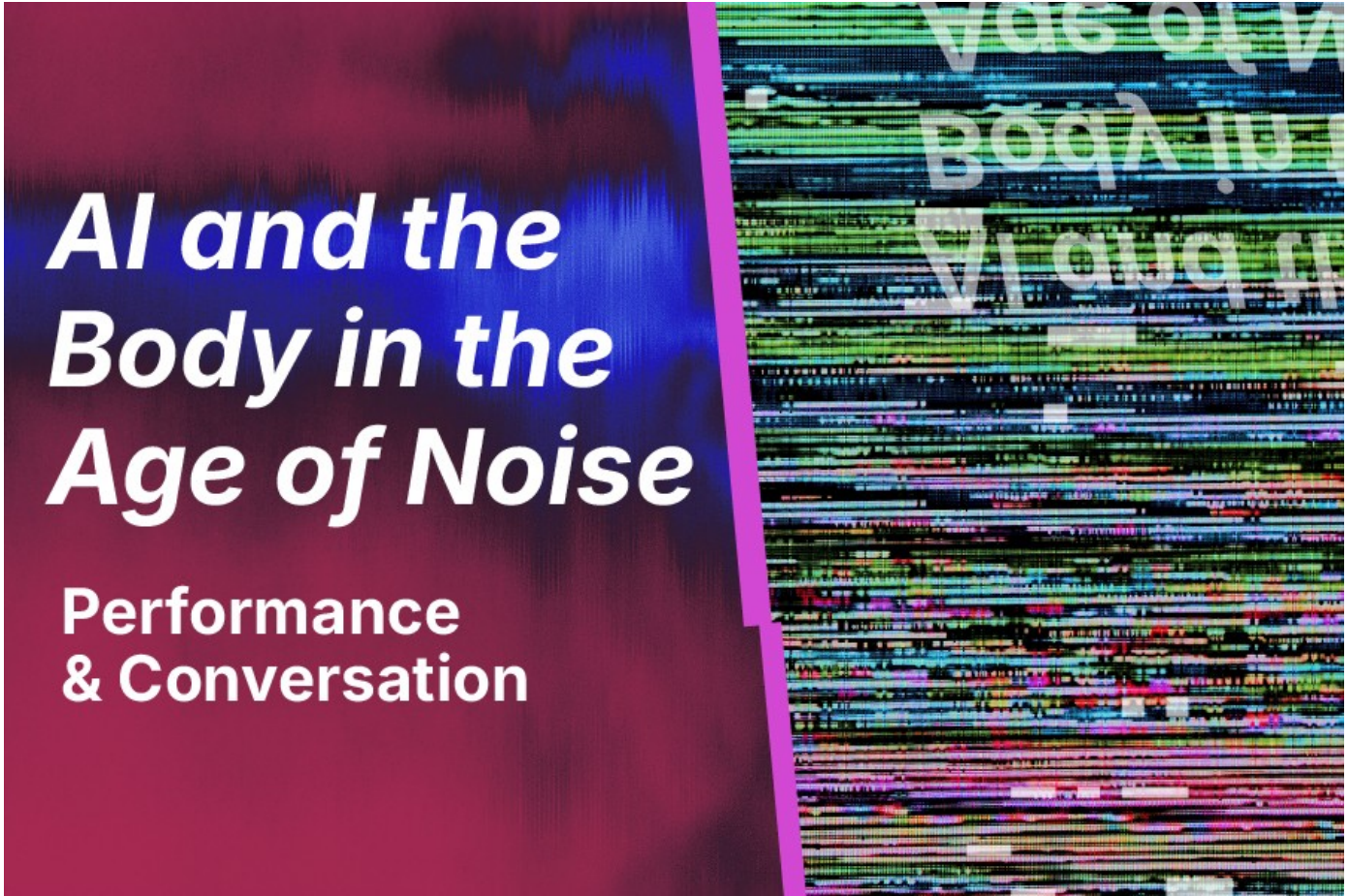
Hallucination Stress Tests II

- Compare:
  - Did the model hallucinate?
  - How confident was it?
  - Did it apologize if corrected?
  - Did it acknowledge uncertainty?
  - What does this tell us about how LLMs work?

“Why Language Models Hallucinate”

- Paper from Open AI researcher
- https://arxiv.org/abs/2509.04664

Tonight: AI and the Body in the Age of Noise



Week 5 Assignment

- Submit a reflection essay on our trip to the HPCC data center and/or about the film we watched Thursday night.